DANI ROYTBURG
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Education

Carnegie Mellon University, School of Computer Science — **Pittsburgh, PA**
M.S., Machine Learning — expected May 2027
Relevant Coursework: Advanced Machine Learning, Probability and Statistics, Probabilistic Graphical Models, Machine Learning in Practice
Service: Executive Board Member, CMU AI Safety Initiative.

Emory University, College of Arts and Science — **Atlanta, GA**
B.S., summa cum laude: Computer Science, Quantitative and Social Sciences. — August 2021-May 2025
Cumulative GPA: 3.85/4.0 | **Dean's List** Spring 2024
Relevant Coursework: Deep Learning, Machine Learning, Privacy-Enhanced Machine Learning, Systems Programming, Computer Architectures, Linear Algebra, Adv. Calculus, Probability and Statistics (I, II), Discrete Math, Algorithmic Analysis.

Work Experience

ML Alignment and Theory Scholars — **Berkeley, CA**
Research Fellow, advised by Shi Feng — May 2026 – present
- Develop persona-training methods which emulate midtraining for better model organisms and constitutions.
- Engineer evaluations across 100+ training runs on synthetic-document pipelines.
- Released an independent evaluation of frontier models' ability to propose tasteful safety research.

DI Group, Carnegie Mellon University — **Pittsburgh, PA**
Research Assistant, advised by Daphne Ippolito — September 2025 – present
- Develop multi-agent reinforcement learning environments to improve legibility of reasoning traces.
- Design user studies and adversarial setups to measure influence of legibility on human and multi-agent interactions.

Martian Research — **San Francisco, CA**
Research Fellow, advised by Jacob Haimes, Phillip Quirke, Narmeen Oozeer — May 2025 – February 2026
- Engineer activation profiles of language model evaluators to suppress self-preferential bias, applied to LLM routers (ICML 2026, MechInterp @ NeurIPS 2025).
- Winner of Mechanistic Router Interpretability Hackathon (40 submissions).

Digital Humanities Lab, Emory University — **Atlanta, GA**
Research Assistant, advised by Lauren Klein and Sandeep Soni — November 2021 – May 2025
- Designed and trained terabyte-scale graph-text models of linguistic network propagation (ICWSM '25).
- Evaluated adversarial robustness of large language models' commonsense reasoning to distributional shift.
- Built historical correspondence networks and analytic dashboards in (D3, Next.js), supported by PBS.

ZS Associates — **Evanston, IL**
Intern – Business Technology Solutions Associate — June 2024 – August 2024
- Automated ETL pipelines from diverse data sources for consumption forecasts of specialty neurological treatments.

Select Publications

Are LLM Evaluators Really Narcissists? Sanity Checking Self-Preference Evaluations (2026)
Dani Roytburg, Narmeen Oozeer et. al, *Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning (**ICML 2026**)*

Measuring Weak-to-Strong Legibility of Reasoning Models (2026)
Dani Roytburg, Shreya Sridhar, Daphne Ippolito. *Trustworthy AI for Good **Workshop @ ICML 2026***

Breaking the Mirror: Activation-Based Mitigation of Self-Preference in LLM Evaluators (2025)
Dani Roytburg, Narmeen Oozeer et. al, *Mechanistic Interpretability, Eval-LLM **Workshops @ NeurIPS 2025***

Mind the Gap: Pathways Towards Unifying AI Safety and Ethics Research (2026)
Dani Roytburg, Beck Miller, *International Association for Safe & Ethical AI (**IASEAI) 2026***

Words and Action: Modeling Linguistic Leadership in #BlackLivesMatter (2025)
Dani Roytburg, Debbie Olorunisola, Sandeep Soni, Lauren Klein, ***AAAI ICWSM 2025***

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, R, JavaScript, Typescript, SQL || French (C1 proficiency), Russian (C1), Chinese (B1)
Packages: PyTorch, JAX, HuggingFace Transformers, scikit-learn, multiprocessing, spaCy, networkx, D3.js
Databases and Deployment: Firebase, Vercel, Amazon EMR, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Docker, MySQL
Dev Tools: Git, Linux, Power BI, Tableau, Figma